

Competition analysis: AllicaBank, Airwallex, Zempler Bank, and Anna

We've recently had a lot of research over Monzo, StarlingBank, and Revolut. However, other players on the market are left neglected so this quick analysis focuses on them. The primary focus of it is what is their main differentiator and what's their Team Expense Card offering.

Item	AllicaBank	Airwallex	Zempler Bank	Anna
Main differentiator	Loans, dedicated relationship manager	Multi currency accounts with corporate cards and FX rates focus	Products beyond mSME. Currency cards (EUR, USD), overdraft, International Bank Payments (EU + USA)	Focuses on Expense management, Taxes and Bank Payments Automation. Tailors offering to different segments: Startups, LTD's, Sole Traders etc. Their free account is actually very very expensive (see below). Offers 1:1 customer support as a selling point.
Physical cards	1 physical card	Coming soon	?	Yes
Virtual cards	20 virtual cards per user	Yes	Yes up to 20 cards	Yes
Subscription approach	Free but balance must be >£10k otherwise £25/month	Free but balance must be >£10k otherwise £19/month 10 free company cards	Sole Trader Free option and paid plans (free charges on incoming/outgoing transfers 35p - only 3 free transfers £9/month gets 20 transfers	Free but 0.95% on all incoming payments, £22.90 Up to 5 expense cards included, £3 per card, per month after that 4 pots included £1/month per pot after

				or £59.90 Unlimited expense cards Unlimited pots
Rewards	Up to 1.5% cashback	?	0% on free 0.5&% on £9 and up to 1% on £19/month plan	Up to 40% cashback
Savings accounts with Interest	Up to 3.83% interest rate	n/a	?	?
Do they have pots?	Not traditional ones, only card level limits. They call a “Saving pot” their Interest rate account.	Not exactly. 1 card with custom limits, shared by multiple team members (mimics budgets). They call it Sales Team Budget.	Pots - marketed as set aside money only. You cannot link cards or make payments using pots.	They call them Saving pots. Allows automatic spending from pots when payment is due. Pots’ types are: Taxes, Payroll or Custom. Can set recurring top-up, % of payments or manual top-up. No limit on the number of pots. No option to link Virtual cards to pots.
Pots Level limits?	No	Daily, monthly, Card, Transaction level limits	?	You set a target amount and start saving. The focus is on the segregation and saving side not on the spending side.
Expense Management	No	Track review and approve spend + Upload receipts + OCR and AI categorisation + Match receipts to expenses automatically	Receipts capture Spending insights	Receipts capture, automatic sorting

Approval workflows	No	Custom approval workflows (web)	No	No
--------------------	----	---------------------------------	----	----

Here are some samples from their web pages:

AllicaBank

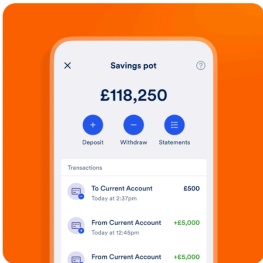


NewEXPENSE CARDS

Easier spending for the whole team

- Earn cashback every time your team spends.³
- Improve security without having to share a single card
- Track your team's spending and improve forecasting
- Freeze cards and set custom limits for full control

See how it works



SAVINGS POT

Help your money make money

Don't leave your company cash sitting idle. Transfer it into your current account's instant access Savings Pot and start earning up to 3.83% AER¹ (variable). Deposit and withdrawal for free any time.

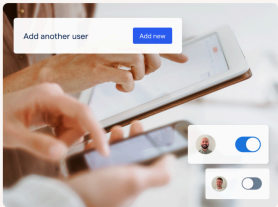
Assisted account opening

Easy money management

Share access with your team

Add to your phone wallet

UK-based human support



Add users to your account with controls on what they can do and how much they can spend.

What are expense cards?

Expense cards are debit cards you can issue to your team, they can either be virtual or physical cards. You stay in control with built-in spend limits and visibility over every transaction. Cardholders can only see their own activity, while account admins get the full view.

Who can get an expense card?

Anyone on your team can have a card. They don't need to go through full identity checks and will only see their own card and transactions.

How many cards can I issue?

Once added, each person in your team can have:

- One physical card
- Up to 20 virtual cards

There's no limit on the number of users you can create cards for.

How business banking used to be, just better

Explore our business bank account

- ✓ Earn up to 3.83% AER¹ (variable) on instant access savings
- ✓ No monthly fees² + up to 1.5% cashback³
- ✓ A relationship manager you can count on

Apply now



Subject to [Eligibility](#) [Terms and Conditions](#) apply.

¹Rate includes standard rate of 2.83% AER (minimum balance applied) plus a 0.5% boost each month if you make 15 bank transfers out of the account in the previous month, and a 0.5% boost for six months if you complete a switch with CASS. Rate correct as of 19th December 2025. 'AER' stands for Annual Equivalent Rate and illustrates what the interest rate would be if interest was paid and compounded once each year. Subject to eligibility – see [Savings Pot Key Product Information](#) for more details.

²Customers whose balance falls below an average of £10,000 in the previous month will incur a £25 monthly fee. This does not apply to customers who hold an active loan product (including an overdraft) with Allica Bank. Account fees are based on average account balance and activity status. See more details [here](#).

³Cashback is variable and based on card spend. Exclusions apply. See a full list of limits and fees [here](#).

Airwallex

CORPORATE CARDS

A smarter approach to spending, locally and globally

Instantly create multi-currency VISA corporate cards with built-in controls, and stay on top of all purchases from a single dashboard, in real-time.

Get started

☒ I consent to receiving marketing communications from Airwallex. I can unsubscribe any time.

Summary Transactions Settings

Cards

Cardholders

All cards 5/165.79 EUR +6% from last month Company cards 6,780.98 EUR +6% from last month

Search on the card numbers, last 8 digit of the card number, cardholder or card contact

Card type Monthly spend in EUR Limit usage

CARDS	CARD NO.	CURRENCY	SPEND	UT
Apple's personal	5173	Apple Pay	769.43 EUR	76
Moby 2	8455	Apple Pay	489.02 EUR	27
Apple's card	7231	Apple Pay	632.12 EUR	1
Use in AI	8153	Business Profile	632.12 EUR	1
Desktop	7853	3 months	850 EUR	1

Design Team **** 5382

Company debit card

Card contacts Billy Wu - Janus_EU

Single use limit 45,000 EUR

Card expenses Enabled

Auto-conversion Enabled

Date of birth 1996-02-06

Mobile +61 412 324 567

ies, Paris 75011, France

1 1079 GZ, Netherlands

STATUS SPEND

In use 727.60 AUD

In use 328.50 SGD

Frozen 28.50 USD

Card limits

Marketing €1,200.00 EUR Remaining Limit €3800.00 EUR

Australia Sales Team €210.00 EUR Remaining Limit €5,090.00 EUR

Card currency

Primary Currency in EUR Euro

Direct Debit Currencies CAD CHF EUR GBP HKD JPY NZD SGD USD

Easily issue cards to your global workforce

Issue multi-currency employee and company cards to your team members around the world to streamline their local and global purchases.

Pay directly from your held balances

Pay global expenses directly from your Wallet Balance, eliminating unnecessary FX conversion fees.

0% foreign card transaction fees

Put an end to surprise foreign transaction fees and other hidden charges, so you can reinvest every dollar back into your growth.

Auto-convert at leading FX rates

If you don't have the necessary currency balance, we'll auto-convert available funds in your home currency at our market-leading FX rates.

COMPANY CARDS

For company expenses and shared team purchases like software subscriptions and ad spend

- Manage company expenses all in one place

Track company card activity and transactions in one place and get a real time view of major corporate purchases.
- Reduce unnecessary spending risks

Avoid personal card use for critical company purchases. Set per transaction limits to reduce the risk of unexpected overspend.
- Consolidate team expenses into a single card

Give multiple team members access to a shared card, and easily manage team budgets with transparency.

Card view

Card details

VIRTUAL

Vertex Inc. **** 5382

Card nickname Marketing

Card status In use

Sales Team Budget

Monthly limit: €1,200.00 EUR

€520.00 EUR remaining

Expenses

Today, 26 November

CHEZIST Cafe, Cairns City, A... 3.04 EUR Ready for review

Jamding Cafe Cairns, CAIRN... 3.04 EUR Ready for review

Stack Technologies, US 675.74 EUR Approved

Monday 22 November

Tokyo Tira Phoenix Baker 29.72 EUR Ready for review

SCMBLACKBIRD ESPRESSO... 2.45 EUR Incomplete

Medium Monthly San Franck... 5.60 USD Approved

Amazon.com 100.90 USD Approved

Connect to accounting software

Chart of Accounts

Locations

Tax rates

Import

Submit expenses on the go

Empower employees to upload receipts and submit expenses on the go via the Airwallex mobile app.

Gain real-time visibility of spend

See a complete view of team expenses in one place and easily explore details of individual transactions.

Manage risk and improve compliance

Design multi-layer approval workflows, set expense submission criteria, and instantly review and approve expenses via mobile.

Eliminate manual data entry with the support of AI

Employees can upload receipts directly and Airwallex will automatically extract all relevant details using OCR technology, no manual data entry needed.

For individual employee purchases like travel, employee benefits, and team offsites



Let your employees purchase on the go

Allow your employees to spend in multiple currencies with **virtual cards**, physical cards (coming soon), Apple Pay, and Google Pay.



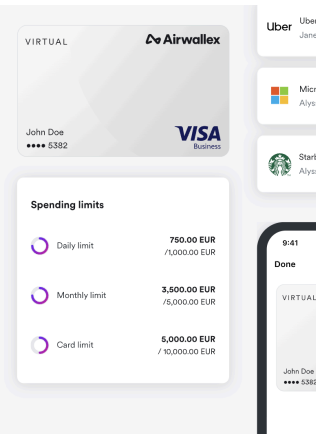
Gain more control of employee spending

Set a variety of spend limits including daily, weekly, monthly, quarterly or annually, to better manage budgets.



Eliminate delayed visibility of purchases

Get a real-time view of employee spend. Each card has a clear payment trail, so it's easy to track purchases.



Spend

- ✓ Multi-currency company and employee cards with zero international fees
- ✓ Batched bill payments
- ✓ 5 free spend users per month⁶
- ✓ Up to 10 free company cards
- ✓ Spend requests, expense management, and reimbursements
- ✓ Domestic and international bill pay (Up to 500 bills per month)⁸

Payments

- ✓ Online card and local payment method acceptance globally
- ✓ Payment links

Integrations

- ✓ Sync bank feeds, expenses, and bills with Xero and QuickBooks
- ✓ ApprovalMax, WorkflowMax by BlueRock integrations⁴
- ✓ Core API access⁵

- ✓ Sync bank feeds, expenses, and bills with Netsuite
- ✓ HRIS platform integrations **NEW**

Yield

- ✓ Higher returns on Yield⁷

Support

- ✓ Dedicated account manager
- ✓ Onboarding support

Explore

For businesses to manage funds, finances and spend globally

€0 or €19 /month

€0/month if you deposit at least €10k per month or hold a minimum balance of €10k⁸

Try it for free

Take a free 1 month trial³

Explore includes:

Business Accounts

- ✓ Multiple accounts per entity
- ✓ Accounts with local bank details in 20+ currencies
- ✓ Free local transfers to 120+ countries, and domestic transfers
- ✓ Access to interbank FX rates
- ✓ International batch transfers
- ✓ Generate returns on your EUR, GBP and USD balances with Yield⁷

Grow

For growing businesses to manage funds and spend with precision and advanced controls

€49 /month

Try it for free

Take a free 1 month trial³

Everything in Explore, plus:

Spend

- ✓ Up to 50 free company cards
- ✓ Customizable, multi-conditional approvals
- ✓ Rules-based automation for bills
- ✓ Approval workflows for vendors **NEW**
- ✓ Remittance advice for bills **NEW**

Yield

- ✓ Higher returns on Yield⁷

Accelerate

For large businesses that require customised workflows and support

From €999 /month

Get started

Everything in Grow, plus:

Enterprise Capabilities

- ✓ Centralised management of finances across global entities
- ✓ Single sign-on **COMING SOON**

Spend

- ✓ Purchase orders and requests **NEW**
- ✓ Advanced rules-based automation for expenses **NEW**

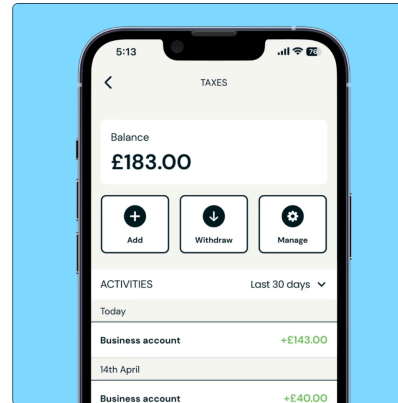
Integrations

Zempler Bank

Business current account features

Pots

Set aside money for whatever you need



✔ **Set aside money today, make use of it tomorrow**

Transfer money into pots to save for surprise expenses, business taxes or to reach future goals. Move your money in and out whenever you want easily and instantly.

✔ **Planning done your way**

Pots sit alongside your main account, ring-fenced but always accessible. Manage your pot in Online Banking and in-app any time, just like your business account.

✔ **Personalise your pot**

Name your pot so you know what it's for. If your priorities shift you can close your pot and open a new one at any time.

✔ **Pots are always protected**

The money in your pots and any accounts you have with Zempler Bank, will be protected by the [Financial Services Compensation Scheme \(FSCS\)](#) up to £120,000 on eligible deposits.

Who can use pots?

Pots are available for free to all Zempler Bank business customers in-app or in Online Banking.

How to get started with pots

- 1 Open your Zempler Bank app or head to Online Banking
- 2 Log in to your account
- 3 Select Create a pot
- 4 You can add money straight away or skip this step and add money later
- 5 Once you have created your pot, you'll be able to view your balance, add and withdraw money, and view your transaction history

Add money

£0

Business Go

£0 monthly

The free business bank account for grafters and self-starters.

- ✔ FSCS protection up to £120,000 on eligible deposits
- ✔ Apply in minutes and bank in-app or online once approved
- ✔ UK telephone customer support from real humans
- ✔ 24/7 account fraud protection
- ✔ Pay in cash at any of the UK's 11,500 Post Offices
- ✔ Tools like cashflow tracking and integrated accounting

Business Extra

£9 monthly

Smart banking built for payments.

- ✔ Everything you get with Business Go, plus:
- ✚ Up to 0.5% cashback on card spend. Limits apply, see 'Show all fees' for details
- ✚ Sending money: 20 free payments & transfers a month
- ✚ In-app messaging support

Business Pro

£19 monthly

The best of everything to help your business boom.

- ✔ Everything you get with Business Go, plus:
- ✚ Up to 1% cashback on card spend. Limits apply, see 'Show all fees' for details
- ✚ Sending money: 500 free payments & transfers a month
- ✚ 0.5% interest earning savings pot (Limits apply. See 'Show all fees' for details)
- ✚ Dedicated Pro support team and in-app messaging

Get more with Zempler Bank Accounts

Customise your business account with useful add-ons and features, available if you need them.

Overdrafts

→

Give your cashflow more flexibility and ease the burden of unexpected expenses.

Travel currency cards

→

Take your business international with local currency cash cards.

Business Creditbuilder

→

Build your business credit score at no extra cost – available with our Business Extra account.

International payments

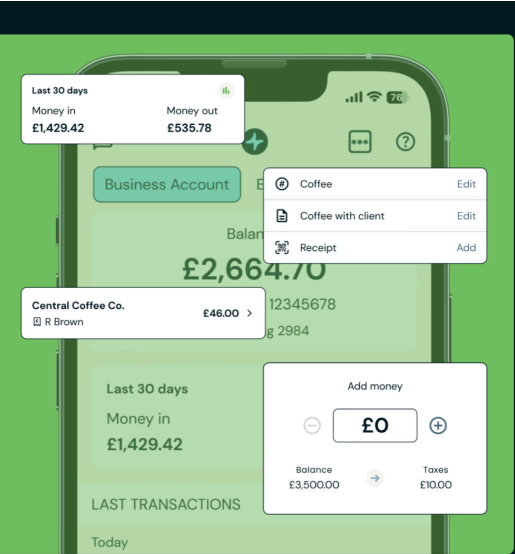
→

Send and receive international payments

✓ Sending money: 3 free payments & transfers a month (35p after)
✓ Receiving money: Free & unlimited
✓ Overdraft with instant decision (eligibility criteria apply)
Business Go card
Free
Cash withdrawals
£2 (UK) £3 (Non-UK)
Receiving money (payments & transfers)
Free & unlimited
Sending money (payments & transfers)
3 free a month (35p after)
Card spend abroad
2.99% non-sterling transaction fee

Business Extra card
Free
Cash withdrawals
Free in the UK and abroad
Receiving money (payments & transfers)
Free & unlimited
Sending money (payments & transfers)
20 free a month (35p after)
Card spend abroad
Fee-free. We'll never charge you for card spend abroad

Business Pro card
Free
Cash withdrawals
Free in the UK and abroad
Receiving money (payments & transfers)
Free & unlimited
Sending money (payments & transfers)
500 free a month (35p after)
Card spend abroad
Fee-free. We'll never charge you for card spend abroad.



Last 30 days

Money in

£1,429.42

Money out

£535.78

Business Account

£2,664.70

Central Coffee Co.

£46.00

Add money

£0

Balance £3,500.00

Taxes £10.00

Tools that drive your business forward

Our business accounts make managing your money simpler. Every account comes with built-in features including:

Integrated accounting

→

Invoice generator

→

Digital receipt capture

→

Spending insights

→

Making Tax Digital tool

→

Cashback

→

ANNA Bank

ANNA

Business account

The business account that does all your taxes

ANNA is the clever all-in-one business account for money, Self Assessment, Corporation Tax, VAT, Payroll and much more

Open an account

Learn more

The business account with money-saving pots

Take the stress out of saving. Create pots and put money aside for taxes, salaries or other expenses. You can manually move your money or set up automatic top-ups, so you always have savings set aside



A card for your business

If you've got your ID to hand, you can get your UK business account and sort code in as little as 10 minutes, with your physical card arriving in the post after a few days



Virtual business expense cards

Don't wait for your ANNA card to arrive in the post – you get a virtual card as soon as you sign up, and can start making payments straight away



Manage multiple cards

Skip the faff of reimbursing employee expenses. Give employees their own ANNA card, set a spending limit and ANNA automatically sorts their expenses



Use Apple Pay

Use ANNA Money with Apple Pay. It's the simple, secure, and private way to pay. There's no need to even carry your card – your iPhone or Apple Watch is enough

[More details and how to set up](#)



Business account cashback

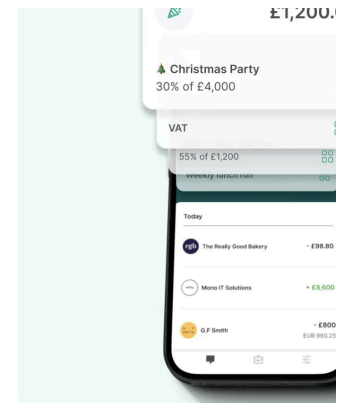
Ker-ching! Get free money for your business: earn cashback when you use your ANNA card to pay for a range of business expenses from train travel to furniture



Use Google Pay

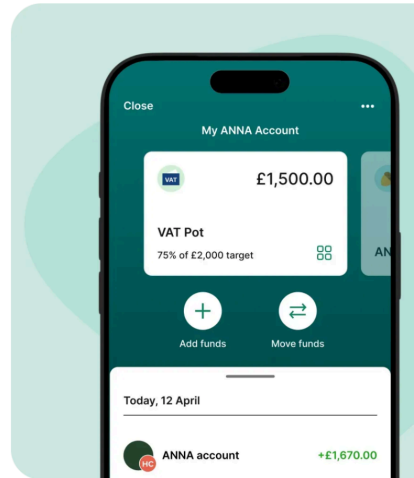
Use ANNA Money with Google Pay™. It's the fast, simple, and secure way to pay at millions of places – on sites, in apps, and in stores. With Google Pay there's no need to dig for your cards – you can pay quickly and easily with the device that's already in your hand.

[More details and how to set up](#)



What are Pots?

Pots are a simple way to organise the money in your ANNA account into separate piles. Instead of keeping everything mixed together, you can set money aside for specific purposes – like VAT, tax, rent, or upcoming bills, and know it's kept separate from your everyday spending. Your money stays in your ANNA account – it's just clearly organised, so you always know what's available.



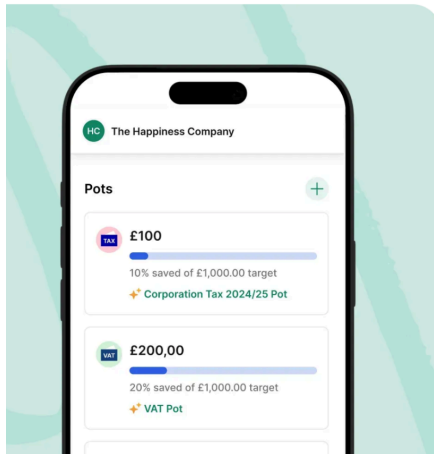
★★★★★ 527 reviews

Business account with smart money pots

Put money aside with smart pots

ANNA Money is the business account that comes with smart pots to help you organise your money. You can create pots in seconds for things like tax or bills, automatically save into them, and even spend directly from a pot when a payment's due, so there's never any last-minute scramble – your money is set aside and ready when you need it.

Get started



Automate payments to saving pots

You can automate moving money into your pots, so saving happens without any extra brain strain.

Set up regular transfers to automatically put money aside – for example, every time you get paid, or on a set date each month. It's an easy way to avoid spending money that should be kept back for important costs.

Pots

Say "Pots" in the ANNA app chat
Simple as that – or choose "Create pot" from the app's thunderbolt menu.

What's this pot for?
☐ VAT
☐ Self Assessment
☐ Something else

Choose pot type
You can have dedicated pots – like for VAT or payroll – or something custom, like a pot for a new pizza oven in your cafe's kitchen.

Set up pot top-ups
Choose how you want the money to be deposited into your new pot. It can be manual, a percentage of every incoming payment, or a fixed recurring amount.

£1,200.00
Payday Pot

£1,500.00
New Van

£160.00
New Laptop

Name and personalise pots

You can name each pot whatever you like, so it's always clear what it's for. Whether it's "VAT", "Tax", "Rent", or "Snazzy new laptop", each pot is easy to recognise at a glance.
This makes it much easier to keep track of your money and

What does ANNA cost?

Pay As You Go
£0 Pay for what you use
Basic account with no monthly fees. You only pay for what you use

- ✓ 0.95% commission on all payments into your account ?
- ✓ No commission on transfers from your own accounts ?

BEST FOR MOST BUSINESSES
Business
£22.90 a month+VAT
Business account with all the essentials to get your business growing

- ✓ First month is free
- ✓ 60 free local transfers
- ✓ Up to 5 free expense cards

Big Business
£59.90 a month+VAT
Unlimited account with everything your business needs to thrive

- ✓ First month is free
- ✓ Unlimited free local transfers
- ✓ Unlimited free expense cards

£3 A MONTH FOR 3 MONTHS
+Taxes add-on
£29.00 a month+VAT
Your bookkeeping, corporation tax, VAT and payroll sorted. LTD companies only

- ✓ Tax calculation & filing
- ✓ Auto-bookkeeping
- ✓ Expert tax support

All payments in and out 0.95% commission on all incoming payments Unlimited outgoing payments	Local bank transfers in and out 60 free transfers per month, 20p per transfer after that	Local bank transfers in and out Unlimited free bank transfers	Extra expense cards Unlimited free expense cards	Extra expense cards Up to 5 expense cards included, £3 per card, per month after that	Extra expense cards Unlimited free expense cards
ATM withdrawals Free ATM withdrawals	ATM withdrawals 3 free ATM withdrawals per month, 1% commission after that, minimum £1 per withdrawal	ATM withdrawals Free ATM withdrawals	Pay cash in Pay cash into your account	Pay cash in Pay in up to £300 cash per month for free, 1% commission after that, minimum £1 per top up	Pay cash in Pay cash into your account commission free
International payments SWIFT payments 1% currency conversion fee for transfers	International payments 2 free SWIFT payments per month, £5 per payment after 1% currency conversion fee for transfers	International payments 4 free SWIFT payments per month, £5 per payment after 0.5% currency conversion fee for transfers	Pots Unlimited pots	Pots 4 free pots, £1 per pot, per month after that	Pots Unlimited pots
CHAPS payments Incoming CHAPS payments	CHAPS payments 2 free CHAPS payments per month, £5 per payment after	CHAPS payments Unlimited free CHAPS payments	Cashback on purchases Up to 40% cash back on over 150 products and services	Cashback on purchases Up to 40% cash back on over 150 products and services	Cashback on purchases Up to 40% cash back on over 150 products and services
Personal payment link for accepting payments Get paid quicker	Personal payment link for accepting payments Free up to £200 per month, 0.5% commission after that	Personal payment link for accepting payments Unlimited incoming payments with no commission	Instant invoicing Professional-looking invoices with QuickPay functionality	Instant invoicing Professional-looking invoices with QuickPay functionality	Instant invoicing Professional-looking invoices with QuickPay functionality
Extra expense cards Unlimited free expense cards	Extra expense cards Up to 5 expense cards included, £3 per card, per month after that	Extra expense cards Unlimited free expense cards	Easy receipt capture Snap receipts and ANNA auto-categorises them	Easy receipt capture Snap receipts and ANNA auto-categorises them	Easy receipt capture Snap receipts and ANNA auto-categorises them

The best online only business bank accounts:

- ANNA business account
- Revolut bank
- Tide business account
- Monzo bank
- Starling bank
- Zempler bank (ex-Cashplus)

ANNA

Revolut

tide

monzo

Starling Bank

ZEMPLER BANK
Formerly Cashplus



Business account

Overview

Business account for
limited companies

International payments
and currency accounts

Business account for
teams

Payment links

Business account for
startups

Pots

Business account for
sole traders

Compare bank accounts

-> <https://anna.money/business-account/compare-bank-accounts/>